

NEOLITHIC & CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES

FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL → DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL → TECHNOLOGY SETTLEMENT SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN → INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP → ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE → CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION SITE-MARKER MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

STAGE 00

FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL MOSAIC

FOOD PRODUCTION

A REGIONAL MOSAIC

MIXED FARMING

SURPLUS/STORAGE WILD USE SELECTIVE TENDING HERITABLE CHANGE CROPS+HERDS DELAYED

NO UNIVERSAL PACKAGE

POLISHED STONE, POTTERY, HERDING AND CROPS APPEAR IN VARIED

NEOLITHIC CHANGES LIFEWAYS; CHALCOLITHIC ADDS COPPER WITHIN STONE-USING ECONOMIES.

FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable

No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.

Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

IMPACT / LIMIT

FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable change crops+herds delayed consumption

Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

STAGE 01

DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL DEBATE

DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL DEBATE

SEED-SIZE/RACHIS CHANGE + WEED ECOLOGY + STORAGE + GRINDING

MORPHOLOGY + AGE/SEX KILL PROFILE + CORRALS/DUNG + HERD

RISK BUFFERING

SOCIAL COMPETITION

NICHE CONSTRUCTION

DOMESTICATION NEEDS CONVERGING BIOLOGICAL AND CONTEXTUAL EVIDENCE. RICE PRESENCE ALONE DOES NOT PROVE CULTIVATION; SECURE DATE

SOURCE / MATERIAL

METHOD / DEBATE

HISTORICAL RESULT

PLANTS: seed-size/rachis change + weed ecology + storage + grinding tools

risk buffering

VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.

ANIMALS: morphology + age/sex kill profile + corrals/dung + herd demography

social competition

Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

CAUSES: climate

niche construction

MECHANISM / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

STAGE 02

TECHNOLOGY SETTLEMENT SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

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POLISHED STONE + MICROLITHS + BONE TOOLS + POTTERY

LONGER RESIDENCE

ACCUMULATED PROPERTY CRAFT/EXCHANGE GROWTH DISEASE, LABOUR LOAD AND DIETARY

polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage →

accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence →

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MECHANISM / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

STAGE 03

INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP

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LONG FARMING/HERDING SEQUENCE BEFORE HARAPPAN URBANISM

BURZAHOM, GUFKRAL

PIT DWELLINGS, BONE TOOLS, AGRO-PASTORALISM

VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA

KOLDIHWA, MAHAGARA, LAHURADEWA

RICE/DATE CAUTIONS

SHOULDERED CELTS AND REGIONAL LINKS; CHRONOLOGY REMAINS UNEVEN

KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism

VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions

NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism

VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions

SOUTH: Utnur, Pikihtal, Tekkalkota, Hallur → cattle, millets, ash mounds

KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

STAGE 04

ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

ASH MOUNDS

FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT

SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND PERIODIC PEN BURNING COMMUNAL FEASTING

REPEATED FIRING AND CATTLE CENTRALITY ARE STRONG; ONE EXCLUSIVE

USE UTNUR AND RELATED SITES AS A PASTORAL-LANDSCAPE PROBLEM

SOURCE / MATERIAL

METHOD / DEBATE

HISTORICAL RESULT

BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice

Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.

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BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

STAGE 05

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES

REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS

GANESHWAR-JODHPURA GANESHWAR/JODHPURA COPPER CRAFT; HARAPPAN CONTACT

AHAR-BANAS AHAR, BALATHAL, GILUND BLACK-RED WARE; COPPER; FARMING

KAYATHA KAYATHA EARLY MALWA SEQUENCE, RICH DEPOSITS MALWA NAVDATOLI, ERAN, NAGDA PAINTED WARE; LARGE VILLAGES; SPREAD JORWE INAMGAON, NEVASA DECCAN HIERARCHY; LATE JORWE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS

Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits

OCPCopper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label

Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact

Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread

Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming

Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

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MECHANISM / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

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WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCPCopper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label.

STAGE 06

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY

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VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS

CROP/HERD PRODUCTION

CRAFT WORK

EXCHANGE UNEQUAL HOUSES RISK AND SURPLUS COPPER/POTTERY REGIONAL NETWORKS

SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY AND DIFFERENTIAL BURIALS MAY INDICATE INEQUALITY.

MOST SYSTEMS WERE REGIONAL AND RURAL, NOT FAILED HARAPPAN

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk

Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks

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MECHANISM / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

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WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

STAGE 07

DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS

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LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE

ARIDITY + PRODUCTION STRESS + SETTLEMENT REORGANISATION SOME ABANDONMENT

CAUTION 1

ARCHAEOLOGICAL CULTURE

MATERIAL PATTERN, NOT A NAMED PEOPLE.

CAUTION 2

COPPER USE DOES NOT DISPLACE STONE OR PROVE URBANISATION.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies

CAUTION 1: archaeological culture = material pattern, not a named people.

CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

+ local continuity

CAUTION 2: copper use does not displace stone or prove urbanisation.

LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies

MECHANISM / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

STAGE 08

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS

DEFINE PHASE

TWO REGIONAL SITES

EVIDENCE CAUTION

15 MARKS

TRANSITION CAUSES

DOMESTICATION PROOF

10 MARKS: define phase → process → two regional sites → evidence caution

15 MARKS: transition causes → domestication proof → technology/settlement → comparison

20 MARKS: mosaic chronology → regional map → Chalcolithic matrix → economy/society

ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

10 MARKS: define phase → process → two regional sites → evidence caution

20 MARKS: mosaic chronology → regional map → Chalcolithic matrix → economy/society

Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.

15 MARKS: transition causes → domestication proof → technology/settlement → comparison

ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

ADVANCED DEBATE

LEGACY / NUANCE

Mini-timeline

4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

Optional Advanced Case Clinics: Evidence Without Overreach — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

1. Snapshot & Core idea

5. UPSC Traps

At Koldihwa, Mahagara, Pachoh and Indari, key issues are dates and whether rice remains are wild or domesticated.

2. Key classification / data

6. Current link

Upinder Singh also highlights Lahuradewa as evidence that the middle Ganga valley was an early rice-cultivation zone, preventing

3. Study links

7. Mains angles

a single north-west-to-east diffusion model.

OPTIONAL STATUS

This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.